

g Silos

Priority sectors

From railways and land record digitisation in the mid-1990s to a focus on providing seamless electronic services, India's e-governance journey has evolved. The government's top priority areas are:

Healthcare

Almost 300 million health IDs have been created under the Ayushman Bharat digital health mission. With health registries and electronic health records, a lot will change in healthcare

Agriculture

To achieve the objective of doubling farmers' income, input costs have to be reduced. For instance, tech like AI and sensors can be leveraged to reduce the amount of water consumed

Natural Language Processing

The government is working on enabling services in multiple Indian languages along with voice interfaces that will be available across departments and sectors

Logistics

Through Gati Shakti, the government is enabling multimodal logistics by helping reduce the cost of compliance, and improving the ease of doing business

Education

The government aims to make digital content available for all grades across sectors to ensure that academic credits allow mobility from one institution to another. Also working on foundational literacy and education using technology

THE NUMBERS are impressive: As of October 2021, more than 1.3 billion Aadhaar cards had been issued to residents of India; monthly digital transactions on the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) were in excess of \$100 billion as of November; and over 100 million unique DigiLocker users had uploaded 5 billion documents as of March 2022. The numbers would suggest that India is going digital with a vengeance. And citizens across the country have logged on to government-provided e-services. While Indians in general have taken to e-services as ducks to water, they're struggling to negotiate the labyrinthine maze of multiple portals, repetitive registration processes for various services, and uploading the same credentials again and again.

The government is aware of its citizens' pain and is working to ease it. "The data has lived in silos in the past. And the government is looking to integrate everything together," assures Abhishek Singh, CEO of Digital India, who was recently appointed the CEO of the National e-Governance Division (NeGD) under the Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology (MeitY). By integrating services on a common architecture and interlinking databases, he says, "we should be able to go to this era of proac-

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